TA studio brief — Studio skills and safe workshop practice

Pathway: TRACK · Week 2 Part 2 · Big question: How do we score, cut, and laminate heavy card safely to build rigid architectural relief?

TA practical setup & focus

Count all cutting/scoring tools out and back in using numbered table blocks; model the standing safety-ruler grip before distributing trays.

Studio kit: A4 self-healing cutting mats, metal safety rulers, scoring blades/craft scissors, greyboard bases, corrugated card, PVA glue, dark acrylic primer

Key words to prompt

• score: To press or lightly indent a line along card so it folds or snaps cleanly.

• laminate: To glue two or more layers of card together for extra thickness and strength.

• gusset: A small angled corner plate that reinforces where two beams meet.

• safety ruler: A ruler with a raised finger guard used to guide straight cuts safely.

• primer: A base coat of paint or wash that unifies mixed card surfaces.

Supported route steps

1. Use the safety ruler and heavy scissors/scorer to cut four straight girder strips along printed guide lines.

2. Laminate two strips together to build a thick horizontal main deck on your base board.

3. Add two diagonal braces and secure the corners with pre-cut triangle gusset plates.

4. Brush a thin dark slate wash over the finished frame.

Check: Safely cut laminated girder frame with gusset corners and unified dark wash.

Review & exit support

Exit question: What is the purpose of gluing two or three card strips on top of each other (lamination) in relief art?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review safe classroom management of cutting mats, safety rulers, and cardboard lamination.